A SOUTH ISLAND ROAD TRIP

NZ NOODLES

QUEENSTOWN → CHRISTCHURCH · 18 DAYS · ONE VAN

6 — 23 NOV 2026
ROUGH ITINERARY



EMOJI KEY

- ✈️ Flights in & out
- 🚐 Driving & the van
- 🥾 Hikes & walks
- ⛺ Huts, campsites & overnight stops
- 🏞️ Explore & sightseeing
- 📸 Photo spots
- 🌅 Sunrise & sunset
- 🌌 Stargazing
- 🏊 Swims
- 🍽️ Food & drink
- 🛒 Supplies
- 😌 Chill time
- 💸 Optional extra ($)
- ❓ Maybe / if time
- 🔁 Possible swap
- ⚠️ Heads-up

COURTNEY — Courtney's plans — anyone's welcome to join!

EVERYONE ELSE — The rest of the crew

DAY BY DAY

FRI 6 — MON 23 NOVEMBER
weather permitting!

FRI 6 — QUEENSTOWN

- ✈️ Alex flies in 7:45pm
- ✈️ Jess flies in 8pm

SAT 7 — QUEENSTOWN

- ✈️ Courtney flies in 2:15pm
- 🏞️ Explore Queenstown
- ✈️ Bradley flies in 6:45pm

SUN 8 — QUEENSTOWN

- 🏞️ Explore Queenstown
- 🍽️ Courtney has brunch plans with a friend
- 🚐 Pick up the van ~3pm
- 🛒 Grocery shop

MON 9 — QUEENSTOWN

- ✈️ Ruby flies in 11:45am
- 🏞️ Stay around Queenstown
- ❓ Maybe visit Arrowtown?

TUE 10 — GLENORCHY

- 🏖️ **Bob's Cove** for a little walk & swim
- 🏞️ Glenorchy

WED 11 — GLENORCHY

- 🥾 **Earnslaw Burn** — 25–29 km round trip

THU 12 — MILFORD SOUND

- 🥾 COURTNEY **Routeburn** (drop-off at Routeburn Shelter)
- 🚐 EVERYONE ELSE Drive to Milford Sound, stopping anywhere on the way (Queenstown, Te Anau, etc.)
- 🏞️ EVERYONE ELSE Explore Milford Sound

FRI 13 — MILFORD SOUND

- 🥾 COURTNEY **Routeburn**
- 🏞️ EVERYONE ELSE Explore Milford Sound; pick up Courtney midday/afternoon from The Divide carpark
- ⛺ Stay somewhere between Milford Sound & Wanaka (depending on how far we want to drive)
- 🍽️ Dinner at Cardrona Hotel?

SAT 14 — WANAKA

- 🚐 Arrive in Wanaka
- 😌 Chill day — or another hike for those who don't like to relax 😅
- 📸 That Wanaka tree
- 🏞️ Explore the lake, etc.
- 💸 COURTNEY May go horse riding, depending on $

SUN 15 — WEST COAST / FOX GLACIER

- ⛺ COURTNEY **Brewster Hut** (dropped off on the way to the West Coast)
- 🚐 EVERYONE ELSE West Coast / Fox Glacier

MON 16 — WEST COAST / FOX GLACIER

- ⛺ COURTNEY Picked up from **Brewster Hut** on the way back to Wanaka
- 🏞️ EVERYONE ELSE West Coast / Fox Glacier, then drive back to Wanaka
- 🥾 **Blue Pools** walk

TUE 17 — WANAKA AREA · MT ASPIRING NP

- ⛺ Hike in to **French Ridge Hut / Liverpool Hut** (16.2 km)
  - ⛺ **Liverpool Hut** — 10 bunks
  - ⛺ **French Ridge Hut** — 20 bunks
- 🚐 Leave the van at Raspberry Flat carpark

WED 18 — WANAKA AREA · MT ASPIRING NP

- ⛺ Hike out of **French Ridge / Liverpool Hut** (16.2 km)
- ⛺ Squeeze in **Rob Roy Glacier Track** (10 km) if time — or keen ones start early from the hut and meet back at the carpark
- 😌 Chill evening, early night

THU 19 — WANAKA → AORAKI MT COOK

- 🌅 **Roys Peak** sunrise hike (3am start; done by 9am)
- 🚐 Depart for the Aoraki Mt Cook area
- 📸 Peter's Lookout
- ⛺ Probably stay in Twizel (pray for White Horse Hill Campground availability)

FRI 20 — AORAKI MT COOK

- ⛺ **Mueller Hut** hike (day or overnight)

SAT 21 — AORAKI MT COOK → LAKE TEKAPO

- ⛺ Hike out of **Mueller Hut** after sunrise
- ❓ **Hooker Valley**, depending on energy levels
- 🚐 Depart for Lake Tekapo in the afternoon (1 hr)
- 😌 Chill evening in Lake Tekapo
- 🌅 Sunset over the lake
- 📸 Church of the Good Shepherd
- 🌌 Dark Sky Reserve — optional 2am night-sky viewing (can be $$)

SUN 22 — LAKE TEKAPO

- 🏞️ Lake Tekapo
- 📸 Morning in the lupin fields (cute photoshoot)
- 🚐 Drive Tekapo → Christchurch (3 hrs); arrive early evening

MON 23 — CHRISTCHURCH AIRPORT

- 🚐 Return the van
- ✈️ Fly out

NOTES

- 🔁 **Milford Sound** — if we cut it, we'd leave Glenorchy on Thu 12 Nov and add those two days to Queenstown, Wanaka or Mt Cook.
- 🔁 **West Coast** (15–16 Nov) and **Liverpool / French Ridge Hut** (17–18 Nov) could be swapped.
- ⚠️ **Aoraki Mt Cook camping** — no availability at White Horse Hill Campground yet, so we may need to stay in Twizel or near Lake Pukaki (~40 min drive; closest town).
- ⚠️ **Mueller Hut** — no overnight availability yet. Last-minute cancellations happen, but 5 spots aren't guaranteed. If staying up there matters to you, bring a tent. If we all stay on the mountain we'll also need a White Horse Hill spot; otherwise 1+ people hike down in the day, park the van in Twizel and come back next day to meet everyone 🥲
- ⚠️ **Weather** — Mt Cook plans are very weather-dependent and may change at short notice (last time I was there, Mt Cook wasn't visible half the time).